



Ink is Where the Money is

1. Do refilled cartridges save money?

Printers are designed for a specific type of ink. Ink cartridges are the cash cow for manufacturers who sell printers at discounted prices. You could circumvent this cartridge cost by refilling a cartridge rather than buying a new one, but you should be aware of the risks. Using non-recommended or spurious ink can affect the printer's performance. It could even damage the printer and void the warranty. A more viable option is to purchase compatible cartridges from third-party manufacturers that are specifically made for your printer.

2. What is the difference between a replacement cartridge and remanufactured cartridge?

Replacement cartridges are manufactured by a third party but are compatible with the printer. Usually there is no difference in quality. A remanufactured cartridge is a used one that is professionally cleaned, refilled and tested.

3. What is a 'universal' refill kit?

Some companies sell kits meant for refilling any cartridge. Technically, each cartridge requires ink of a special chemical formulation for it to function correctly. For

the most part, inks are not interchangeable between cartridges.

4. Will using compatible cartridges or refilling my cartridge void the warranty?

If a printer is damaged because of a modified or refilled cartridge, the cost of repairs will not be covered under the warranty.

5. How often should I replace my cartridge?

Replace it as soon as it dries up. If you keep a dried up cartridge plugged in for a long period of time (more than two weeks) then the print head can get clogged, causing poor quality prints and inefficient use of ink.

Performance Award with ease. Print quality was where it really shone and it won the text printing round hands down along with the photo quality round.

The Best Value Award in this segment goes to the **Epson Stylus Photo 810**. A high-end printer filled with features for as low as Rs 14,000 is hard to beat. It displayed a perfect balance between printing speed and quality and came in close behind the winners in most of the tests. For a high-end printer, it achieves a wonderfully low cost per page of Rs 4.90. This printer will print pages by the reams at high speed without burning a hole in your pocket.

The Winners!

Lexmark Z25: The Lexmark Z25 weighs just 2.2 kg and sports good solid looks. It features a retractable paper tray, which could save some desktop space when the device is not in use. This printer features a maximum resolution of 1200x1200, which is good enough for photo quality printouts too. It has a USB interface and getting the device up and running is no problem at all—all you have to do is connect the device and load its drivers. However, the absence of a parallel port means that you cannot connect it to older PCs. This printer sports some fun features too, such as the ability to print on iron-on transfers that let you print and transfer an image to your T-shirt.

The software included

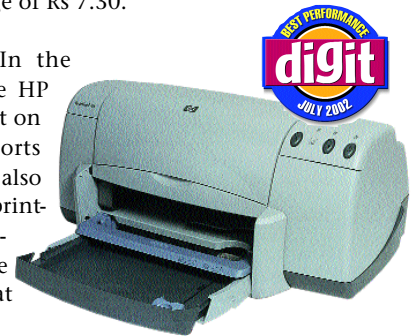


Fast print speeds and very decent print quality makes the Lexmark Z25 a hot choice in the budget segment

in the package features a user-friendly interface and monitors the ink levels quite accurately. The package includes a manual and a data cable and though there is no printing media included, it is attractively priced at Rs 4,500. However, it has a relatively high cost per page of Rs 7.30.

HP DeskJet 920C:

In the mid-range section, the HP Deskjet 920C comes out on top. This printer supports dual-sided printing and also features photo quality printing and iron-on transfers. There are three LEDs on the device that alert you in case of paper jam, low ink or if there's no paper in the input tray. The package includes a data cable, manual and driver CD. The HP Deskjet 920C features a maximum resolution of 2400x1200 dpi and sports both the USB and parallel ports. It has 2 MB of onboard buffer and a paper capacity of 100 pages. This printer costs approximately Rs 8,000 and has a cost per page of Rs 5.90.



The HP Deskjet 920c is a great choice for those who demand good image quality and don't mind a slightly slower printing speed

HP DeskJet 970CXi: When it comes to near perfect image quality and good printing speed, this printer delivers. The printer features a 4 MB buffer and provides a USB as well as a parallel interface. It supports a paper capacity of a hefty 150 sheets—an advantage for those who print in large quantities. It also supports

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